CalHacks: Build agents that trade and pay

TL;DR

Build an agent that trades, manages a portfolio, pays for things with x402, or earns money. Use Coinbase for Agents to bring your idea to life as a working agent, reusable skill, template, or integration.

Two tracks

Track	Challenge	Examples
Payment Agents	Give an agent a way to pay for things, earn money, or both. Use the Coinbase MCP for Agents and x402 to explore what an agent can do when it can participate in commerce.	An agent that buys tools to finish a job; sells research or a service; hires another agent; or manages the budget for a small business.
Trading Agents	Build your take on agentic trading and portfolio management. Use Coinbase for Agents or the Coinbase Wallet MCP. Explore short-term strategies, long-term investing, or a new way to research and manage a portfolio.	A trading strategy template; a portfolio management tool; an agent that tests investment ideas; or a skill for monitoring markets and acting on user-defined signals.

Prize

For each track, **one** winning team will be selected. Each eligible team members will receive:

- $500 USDC
- A call with an Emerging Talent recruiter

See Terms and Conditions below

What you can build

Coinbase for Agents is an MCP to give your agent a financial account. Start with an existing agent platform (Grok Bot, Instinct, Muse, etc.) or build your own. Skills, templates, integrations, and GitHub starter kits are eligible in either track. You don't need to build a standalone app.

Package a trading idea as a template others can customize. Give an existing agent a skill for buying or selling services. Build a hosted agent that keeps working when your laptop is closed. These are starting points; choose the problem and architecture you want to explore.

Getting Started

1. Create a Coinbase account to be eligible for the prize.
2. Review the documentation at https://docs.cdp.coinbase.com/ai-agents/overview and https://docs.cdp.coinbase.com/x402/welcome and get an API key at portal.cdp.coinbase.com

How we'll judge

- **Usefulness:** Does it solve a clear problem for an identifiable user?
- **Technical design:** Does it work reliably? Where relevant, explain your choices of models, tools, memory, and scheduling.
- **Ease of reuse:** Can another person install or access it and complete the core task using your instructions?
- **Product feedback:** Insightful, actionable feedback about your experience building with Coinbase for Agents.

We won't score projects on code volume, trading returns, or money spent. Real-money transactions are not required. Label simulated actions clearly, keep credentials private, and don't manage funds for other people.

What to submit

Choose one primary track and include:

- **Project summary:** Who it's for, what it does, and which agent platform and Coinbase tools it uses.
- **Working example:** A short demo and a repo, installable skill/template, or hosted link with setup instructions.

- **Architecture:** A brief explanation or diagram showing the components, controls, and known limitations.
- **Builder feedback:** Your biggest blocker, how you worked around it, and the one missing Coinbase capability you most want.

You can also opt into a follow-up conversation with the Coinbase team. We'll ask separately before featuring your project publicly.

Terms & Conditions

No purchase necessary. Participation is limited to individuals who are: (i) at least 18 years old at the time of participation; (ii) legal residents of the United States or Canada (excluding Quebec); and, (iii) who have, or create prior to participation, and a verified Coinbase account. Participant must follow the Coinbase CalHacks Prompt by submitting their project summary, example, architecture, and builder feedback. Submissions will be judged by criteria which is the sole discretion of Coinbase. Judging criteria includes usefulness, technical design, and ease of reuse. Each eligible member of the winning team for each Prompt track will receive a one (1) $500 in USDC and a call with a recruiter from Coinbase. Limit of one (1) prize per person. Winners may be be required to complete an affidavit to claim the prize. Canadian winners may be required to answer a skill-based question to claim the prize. Coinbase reserves the right to suspend, cancel or modify the Prompt if it can't be executed as planned for any reason including, but not limited to fraud, human error, technical failures, or any other factor that impairs the integrity or proper functioning. The person participating must be the authorized account holder of the verified Coinbase account, otherwise participation may be deemed void. Acceptance of a prize constitutes permission for Coinbase and its affiliates to use a winner's name, likeness, photograph, submitted content and/or hometown and state for advertising and trade without further compensation, in any media, worldwide, unless prohibited by law. Coinbase is not responsible for technical issues that prevent or disrupt participation. Participation in this Challenge - including any exploratory conversation with an Emerging Talent recruiter and the submission of Challenge materials - does not create an employment or contractor relationship or any expectation of employment with Coinbase, constitute a job application or interview, or guarantee consideration for or preference in any role. Any internship or employment opportunity referenced in connection with this Challenge is subject to Coinbase's standard recruiting process, including separate application, interview, and hiring criteria. Coinbase makes no representation that any participant will be interviewed, hired, or considered for any position. Your participation, including all disputes arising from or related to participation in this bounty, are subject to the applicable U.S. Coinbase User Agreement for U.S. residents or Canada Coinbase User Agreement for Canadian residents, and the Privacy Policy based on your country of residence; in the event of any conflict between the Coinbase User Agreement and the Coinbase Wallet Terms of Service, the Coinbase User Agreement shall prevail.